

Encounter Cards

Encounter Cards are seeded into and revealed from the Encounter Deck. Cards on the Stewards Board are open information. Players may inspect active cards, completed Arrivals, active Burdens, and face-up Boons.

Encounter Type	When Revealed
Boon	Resolve the current Season effect. If it modifies a later action or future event, keep it face-up according to its text.
Burden	Apply the current Season effect. Place the card on the Stewards Board as an active Burden.
Arrival	Place it on the Stewards Board with 3 timer tokens. Players may complete it by fulfilling its Requirement and spending an Interact action.
Golden Boon	Resolve according to its unique Effect text and Golden Boon rules. It does not count toward the standard Encounter Cards revealed that round.

Arrivals And Special Tiles

- An Arrival enters play with 3 timer tokens.
- To complete an Arrival, fulfill its Requirement all at once and spend 1 Action to interact with it.
- Arrival resource Requirements cannot be partly paid over time.
- At the end of each round, each active Arrival loses 1 timer token. If it reaches 0 before completion, it expires.
- A completed Arrival unlocks its Special Tile. Any player may later place that unlocked Special Tile with a normal Place a Tile action.
- Unlocked but unplaced Special Tiles are not on the map and have no effects until placed.

Burdens

- When a Burden is revealed, apply the current Season effect and then place it on the Stewards Board as an active Burden.
- Unresolved active Burdens reapply at the start of Round 6 using Season II text and at the start of Round 11 using Season III text.
- If a Burden places Strain, choose valid tiles with fewer than 3 Strain. If there are fewer valid tiles than requested, choose all valid tiles.
- If no valid target exists, no Strain is placed for that application. The Burden remains active unless resolved.
- Some Season III Burdens include fallback targets or Season III-only resolution. Use the text printed on that card rather than memorising a separate list.
- Resolving a Burden removes it from the Stewards Board and prevents future reapplications. It does not remove Strain already placed.

PLAYTEST FOCUS

Players should notice active Burdens. Leaving them unresolved can create repeated pressure and final score penalties.